

# REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)

## *Cloud-Native Application Orchestration & Deployment*

|                                 |                                                 |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Tender Reference Number:</b> | DESC-MRD-2026-CNC-088                           |
| <b>Issuing Organization:</b>    | DESC Digital Innovation Center, Mardan          |
| <b>Contract Duration:</b>       | 1 Year (12 Months) Managed Service              |
| <b>Submission Deadline:</b>     | <b>Sunday, 14th June 2026, 11:00 AM (Sharp)</b> |

### 1. Project Overview

DESC Digital Innovation Center in Mardan is seeking a specialized Cloud Architecture firm to modernize, orchestrate, and manage a high-traffic citizen portal. The current legacy infrastructure struggles with load spikes. We require a robust, scalable, and resilient Cloud-Native architecture to containerize and 'spin up' our microservices applications efficiently, ensuring 99.99% uptime and rapid deployment cycles without service interruption.

### 2. Scope of Work

The selected consulting firm will be responsible for designing, deploying, and demonstrating a full cloud-native pipeline. Proposals must cover:

- **Containerization Strategy:** Dockerizing the existing monolithic components into isolated, efficient microservices.
- **Container Orchestration:** Designing and provisioning a Kubernetes (K8s) cluster architecture for automated scaling, self-healing, and load balancing.
- **CI/CD Pipeline Automation:** Implementing a continuous integration and continuous deployment (CI/CD) pipeline (e.g., GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, or ArgoCD) for automated testing and zero-downtime rollouts.
- **Infrastructure as Code (IaC):** Utilizing tools like Terraform or Ansible to automate the provisioning of the cloud environment.
- **Observability & Monitoring:** Integrating comprehensive logging and metrics monitoring (e.g., Prometheus, Grafana) to track cluster health and resource utilization.

### 3. Submission Guidelines

Bidders must submit their proposals strictly adhering to a Two-Envelope system:

- **Envelope A (Technical Proposal):**

Must include the proposed Kubernetes architecture diagram, the GitOps/deployment workflow, chosen toolstack, and strategies for stateful data and security. No pricing information should be visible.

- Envelope B (Financial Proposal):

Must include a comprehensive cost breakdown. This includes estimated cloud provider costs (compute/storage), pipeline setup fees, and a 1-year managed service retainer.

#### **4. Evaluation Criteria**

Bids will be evaluated to identify the most advantageous solution based on:

- Technical Architecture & Best Practices (40%): Efficiency of the K8s cluster design, CI/CD automation logic, and adherence to cloud-native security principles.
- Live Deployment Demonstration (30%): The ability to successfully 'spin up' a sample multi-tier application live before the evaluation board, demonstrating load balancing or auto-scaling.
- Financial Competitiveness (30%): Realistic cloud resource forecasting and overall cost-effectiveness for the setup and 1-year duration.

#### **5. Strict Deadline & Compliance**

Both Technical and Financial proposals, along with readiness for the live application spinning demonstration, must be submitted no later than Sunday, 14th June 2026, at 11:00 AM Sharp. Late submissions will be automatically disqualified.